Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox

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Employment

Assistant Professor of Computational Linguistics, Georgetown University — Washington, D.C.
Department of Linguistics — 8/2024 - present

ETH Postdoctoral Fellow, ETH Zürich — Zürich, Switzerland
Department of Computer Science, Institute of Machine Learning — 9/2022 - 8/2024

Research and Teaching Areas

- Computational and information-theoretic models of sentence processing and language acquisition
- Natural language processing, focusing on interpretability and analysis of large language models
- Experimental psycholinguistics including syntactic processing, reading, experimental methods

Education

Ph.D. in Linguistics, Harvard University — Cambridge, MA
Dissertation Title: "Informative Presupposition and Accommodation" — 9/2017 - 5/2022

- Visiting scholar, Department of Cognitive Science, Ecole Normale Supérieure (Summer 2018)

B.A.S., Stanford University — Stanford, CA
Degree in in Symbolic Systems and Slavic Languages and Literature with Honors — 9/2011 - 8/2015

Journal Articles

[1] Cui Ding, **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**, Lena A. Jäger. "Individual Signatures of Spillover in Naturalistic Reading", *Accepted, Journal of Memory and Language*

[2] Xiulin Yang, Arianna Bisazza, Nathan Schneider, **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**. "A Unified Assessment of the Poverty of the Stimulus Argument for Neural Language Models", *Under Review, Transactions of the Association for Computational Linguistics*

[3] Autumn Toney, Leticia Bode, Tiago Ventura, **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**, Lisa Singh. "Comparing the Humanness of Machine-Generated and Human-Authored Text", *ACM Computing Surveys*, 2026

[4] Jennifer Hu, **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**, Siyuan Song, Kyle Mahowald, Roger Levy. "What Can String Probability Tell Us About Grammaticality?", *Transactions of the Association for Computational Linguistics*, 2026

[5] Metehan Oğuz, Cui Ding, **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**, Zuzanna Fuchs. "Using MoTR to Probe Gender Agreement in Russian", *OpenMind*, 2025

[6] Brandon Waldon, Nathan Schneider, **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**, Amir Zeldes, Kevin Tobia. "Large Language Models for Legal Interpretation? Don't Take Their Word for It", *Georgetown Law Journal*, 2025

[7] Anna A. Ivanova, Aalok Sathe, Benjamin Lipkin, Unnathi Kumar, Setayesh Radkani, Thomas H. Clark, Carina Kauf, Jennifer Hu, R. T. Pramod, Gabriel Grand, Vivian Paulun, Maria Ryskina, Ekin Akyürek, **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**, Nafisa Rashid, Leshem Choshen, Roger Levy, Evelina Fedorenko, Joshua Tenenbaum, Jacob Andreas. "Elements of World Knowledge (EWOK): A cognition-inspired framework for

evaluating basic world knowledge in language models", *Transactions of the Association for Computational Linguistics*, October 2025

[8] **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**, Michael Y. Hu, Alex Warstadt, Aaron Mueller, Leshem Choshen, Chengxu Zhuang, Adina Williams, Ryan Cotterell, Tal Linzen. "Bigger is not always better: The importance of human-scale language modeling for psycholinguistics", *Journal of Memory and Language*, October 2025

[9] **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**, Cui Ding, Mrinmaya Sachan, Lena Jäger. "Mouse Tracking while Reading (MoTR): A New Incremental Processing Measurement", *Journal of Memory and Language*, October 2024

[10] **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**, Tiago Pimentel, Clara Meister, Ryan Cotterell. "An Information-Theoretic Analysis of Targeted Regressions During Reading", *Cognition*, August 2024.

[11] **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**, Richard Futrell and Roger Levy. "Using Computational Models to Test Syntactic Learnability", *Linguistic Inquiry*, October 2024.

[12] **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**, Tiago Pimentel, Clara Meister, Ryan Cotterell, Roger Levy. "Testing the Predictions of Surprisal Theory in 11 Languages," *Transactions of the Association for Computational Linguistics*, 2023.

[13] Alexandre Cremers, **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**, Benjamin Spector. "Exhaustivity and Anti-Exhaustivity in the RSA Framework: Testing the Effect of Prior Beliefs", *Cognitive Science*, 2023.

[14] Tiago Pimentel, Clara Miester, **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**, Roger Levy and Ryan Cotterell. "On the Effect of Anticipation on Reading Times ", *Transactions of the Association for Computational Linguistics*, 2023.

Conference Proceedings

[1] Wesley Scivetti, **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**, Nathan Schneider. "Slot-Filling Machines? Type frequency and distributional skewness condition learning of abstract slots in constructions" *Under Review, ACL Rolling Review*, 2026

[2] Lanni Bu, Xiulin Yang, Christian Clark, Alex Warstadt, **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**. "Beyond Static and Linear: What Attention Constraints Best Fit Human Reading Times?" *Under Review, ACL Rolling Review*, 2026

[3] Junghyun Min, Alex Warstadt, Tamar Regev, Tiago Pimentel, **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**. "Using Prosody to Predict Syntactic Structure" *Proceedings of the 2026 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP)*, 2026

[4] Kohei Kajikawa, Lin Ai, Tatsuki Kuribayashi, **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**. "Using Language Models to Model the Effects of Context and Coreference during Sentence Comprehension" *Proceedings of the 2026 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP)*, 2026

[5] Xiulin Yang, **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**, Catherine Arnett. "Apples to Apples? Towards Comparable Crosslingual Language Model Evaluation" *Proceedings of the 2026 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP)*, 2026

[6] Tatsuya Aoyama, **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox** Nathan Schneider. "Predicting the Emergence of Induction Heads in Language Model Pretraining" *International Conference on Machine Learning*, 2026

[7] Tatsuki Kuribayashi, Alex Warstadt, Yohei Oseki, **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**. "Dual Alignment Between Language Model Layers and Human Sentence Processing" *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Association of Computational Linguistics (ACL)*, 2026

[8] Xiulin Yang, Heidi Getz, **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**. "Function Words as Statistical Cues for Language Learning" *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Association of Computational Linguistics (ACL)*, 2026

[9] Kohei Kajikawa, Shinnosuke Isono, **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**. "Information-Theoretic Storage Cost in Sentence Comprehension" *Proceedings of the Conference on Natural Language Learning (CoNLL)*, 2026

[10] Wesley Scivetti, **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**, Nathan Schneider, Kanishka Misra, Leonie Weissweiler. "Language Models Learn Constructional Semantics, Not To Mention Syntax: Investigating LM Understanding of Paired-Focus Constructions" *Proceedings of the Conference on Natural Language Learning (CoNLL)*, 2026

[11] Alex Warstadt, Aditya Yadavali, Tamar Regev, Tiago Pimentel, **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**. "What Do Prosody and Text Convey? An Information-Theoretic Framework to Quantify the Transmission of Meaning Across Multiple Channels" *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Association of Computational Linguistics (ACL)*, 2026

[12] Tatsuya Aoyama, Nathan Schneider, **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**. "Predicting the Formation of Induction Heads" *Proceedings of CogInterp: Interpreting Cognition in Deep Learning Models (co-located with NeurIPS)*, 2025

[13] Lucas Charpentier, Leshem Choshen, Ryan Cotterell, Mustafa Omer Gul, Michael Y. Hu, Jing Liu, Jaap Jumelet, Tal Linzen, Aaron Mueller, Candance Ross, Raj Sanjay Shah, Alex Warstadt, **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**, Adina Williams. "Findings of the Third BabyLM Challenge: Accelerating Language Modeling Research with Cognitively Plausible Data" *Proceedings of the Third BabyLM Workshop*, 2025

[14] Cui Ding, Lena Jäger, **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**. "Modeling Bottom-up Information Quality during Language Processing" *Proceedings of the 2025 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP)*, 2025

[15] Wesley Scivetti, Tatsuya Aoyama, **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**, Nathan Schneider. "Unpacking Let Alone: Human-Scale Models Generalize to a Rare Construction in Form but not Meaning" *Proceedings of the 2025 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP)*, 2025

[16] **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**, Cui Ding, Giovanni Acampa, Tiago Pimentel, Alex Warstadt, Tamar I. Regev, "Using Information Theory to Characterize Prosodic Typology: The Case of Tone, Pitch-Accent and Stress-Accent" *Proceedings of the 2025 Conference of the Association of Computational Linguistics*, 2025

[17] Eleftheria Tsipidi, Samuel Kiegeland, Franz Nowak, Tianyang Xu, **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**, Alex Warstadt, Ryan Cotterell, Mario Giulianelli. "The Harmonic Structure of Information Contours" *Proceedings of the 2025 Conference of the Association of Computational Linguistics*, 2025

[18] Tamar I. Regev, Chiebuka Ohams, Shaylee Xie, Lukas Wolf, Evelina Fedorenko, Alex Warstadt, **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**, Tiago Pimentel, "The time scale of redundancy between prosody and linguistic context" *Proceedings of the 2025 Conference of the Association of Computational Linguistics*, 2025

[19] Xiulin Yang, Tatsuya Aoyama, Yuekun Yao, **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**, "Anything Goes? A Crosslinguistic Study of (Im)possible Language Learning in LMs" *Proceedings of the 2025 Conference of the Association of Computational Linguistics*, 2025

[20] Tatsuya Aoyama, **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**, "Language Models Grow Less Humanlike beyond Phase Transition" *Proceedings of the 2025 Conference of the Association of Computational Linguistics*, 2025

[21] Michael Hu, Aaron Mueller, Candace Ross, Adina Williams, Tal Linzen, Chengxu Zhuang, Ryan Cotterell, Leshem Choshen, Alex Warstadt, **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**, "Findings of the Second BabyLM Challenge: Sample-Efficient Pretraining on Developmentally Plausible Corpora" in *Proceedings of the 2024 BabyLM Challenge*, 2025

[22] Eleftheria Tsipidi, Franz Nowak, Ryan Cotterell, **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**, Mario Giulianelli, Alex Warstadt. "Surprise! Uniform Information Density Isn't the Whole Story: Predicting Surprisal Contours in Long-form Discourse" in *Proceedings of the 2024 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP)*, 2024

[23] Samuel Kiegeland*, **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox***, Afra Amini, David Robert Reich, Ryan Cotterell. "Reverse Engineering the Reader" in *Proceedings of the 2024 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP)*, 2024

[24] Andreas Opedal, Eleanor Chodroff, Ryan Cotterell, **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**. "On the Role of Context in Reading Time Prediction " in *Proceedings of the 2024 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP)*, 2024

[25] Samuel Kiegeland, David Robert Reich, Ryan Cotterell, Lena Ann Jäger, **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**. "The Pupil Becomes the Master" in *Proceedings of the 2024 ICML Workshop on LLMs and Cognition*, 2024

[26] **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**, Clara Meister, Ryan Cotterell, Tiago Pimentel. "Language Model Quality Correlates with Psychometric Predictive Power in Multiple Languages" in *Proceedings of the 2023 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP)*, 2023

[27] Tiago Pimentel, Clara Meister, **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**, Ryan Cotterell, Kyle Mahowald. "Revisiting the Optimality of Word Lengths", in *Proceedings of the 2023 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP)*, 2023

[28] Lukas Wolf, Tiago Pimentel, Evelina Fedorenko, Ryan Cotterell, Alex Warstadt, **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**, Tamar Regev. "Quantifying the redundancy between prosody and text", in *Proceedings of the 2023 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP)*, 2023

[29] Lukas Wolf, Klemen Kotar, Greta Tuckute, Eghbal Hosseini, Alex Warstadt, **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**, Tamar Regev. "WhisBERT: Multimodal Text-Audio Language Modeling on 100M Words", in *Proceedings of the 2023 BabyLM Challenge*, 2023

[30] Alex Warstadt, Aaron Mueller, Leshem Choshen, **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**, Chengxu Zhuang, Juan Ciro, Rafael Mosquera, Adina Williams, Bhargavi Paranjabe, Tal Linzen, Ryan Cotterell. "Findings of the BabyLM Challenge: Sample-efficient Pretraining on Developmentally Plausible Corpora", in *Proceedings of the 2023 BabyLM Challenge*, 2023

[31] Clara Meister, Tiago Pimentel, Luca Malagutti, **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**, Ryan Cotterell. "On the Efficacy of Sampling Adapters", in *Proceedings of the 61st Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (Volume 1: Long Papers)*, 2023

[32] Wangchunshu Zhou, Yuchen Jiang, **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**, Ryan Cotterell, Mrinmaya Sachan. "Controlled Text Generation with Natural Language Instructions", in *Proceedings of the International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML)*, 2023

[33] Thomas Clark, **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**, Edward Gibson, Roger Levy. "Which Evidence for Availability Effects on Speaker Choice in the Russian Comparative Alternation", in *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*, 2022

[34] **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**, Roger Levy, Kathryn Davidson. "Which Presuppositions are Subject to Contextual Felicity Constraints? ", in *Proceedings of the Semantics and Linguistic Theory (SALT)*, 2021

[35] **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**, Pranali Vani, Roger Levy. "A Targeted Assessment of Incremental Processing in Neural Language Models and Humans", in *Proceedings of the 59th Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics and the 11th International Joint Conference on Natural Language Processing (Volume 1: Long Papers)*, 2021

[36] Pranali Vani, **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**, Roger Levy. "Using the interpolated maze task to assess incremental processing in English relative clauses", in *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*, 2021

[37] **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**, Jon Gauthier, Jennifer Hu, Peng Qian, Roger Levy. "On the Predictive Power of Neural Language Models for Human Real-Time Comprehension Behavior", in *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*, 2020

[38] **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**, Peng Qian, Richard Futrell, Ryosuke Kohita, Roger Levy, Miguel Ballesteros. "Structural Supervision Improves Few-Shot Learning and Syntactic Generalization in Neural Language Models", in *Proceedings of the 2020 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP)*, 2020

[39] Tristan Thrush, **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**, Roger Levy. "Investigating Novel Verb Learning in BERT: Selectional Preference Classes and Alternation-Based Syntactic Generalization", in *Proceedings of the Third BlackboxNLP Workshop on Analyzing and Interpreting Neural Networks for NLP*, 2020

[40] Jennifer Hu, Peng Qian, Jon Gauther, **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**, Roger Levy. "A Systematic Assessment of Syntactic Generalization in Neural Language Models", in *Proceedings of the 58th Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics*, 2020

[41] Jon Gauther, Jennifer Hu, **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**, Peng Qian, Roger Levy. "SyntaxGym: An Online Platform for Targeted Evaluation of Language Models", in *Proceedings of the 58th Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics: System Demonstrations*, 2020

[42] **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**, Roger Levy, Richard Futrell. "What syntactic structures block dependencies in RNN language models?", in *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*, 2019

[43] Richard Futrell, **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**, Takashi Morita, Peng Qian, Miguel Ballesteros, Roger Levy. "Neural language models as psycholinguistic subjects: Representations of syntactic state", in *Proceedings of the 2019 Conference of the North American Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics: Human Language Technologies, Volume 1 (Long and Short Papers)*, 2019

[44] **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**, Peng Qian, Richard Futrell, Miguel Ballesteros, Roger Levy. "Structural Supervision Improves Learning of Non-Local Grammatical Dependencies", in *Proceedings of the 2019 Conference of the North American Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics: Human Language Technologies, Volume 1 (Long and Short Papers)*, 2019

[45] Aixiu An, Peng Qian, **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**, Roger Levy. "Representation of Constituents in Neural Language Models: Coordination Phrase as a Case Study", in *Proceedings of the 2019 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing and the 9th International Joint Conference on Natural Language Processing (EMNLP-IJCNLP)*, 2019

[46] **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**, Roger Levy, Richard Futrell. "Hierarchical Representation in Neural Language Models: Suppression and Recovery of Expectations", in *Proceedings of the 2019 ACL Workshop BlackboxNLP: Analyzing and Interpreting Neural Networks for NLP*, 2019

[47] **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**, Benjamin Spector. "The Role of Prior Beliefs in The Rational Speech Act Model of Pragmatics: Exhaustivity as a Case Study", in *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*, 2019

[48] **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**, Roger Levy, Takashi Morita, Richard Futrell. "What do RNN Language Models Learn about Filler–Gap Dependencies?", in *Proceedings of the 2018 EMNLP Workshop BlackboxNLP: Analyzing and Interpreting Neural Networks for NLP*, 2018.

Book Chapters

[1] John Mansfield, **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**. "Looking Forward: Linguistic Theory and Methods", *Routledge Handbook of Linguistics*, 2026

[2] **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**, Jon Gauthier, Peng Qian, Jennifer Hu and Roger Levy "Learning Syntactic Structures from String Input", Algebraic Structures in Natural Language , 2022 (pp. 113-138). CRC Press.

Commentary & Squibs

[1] **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**, Elissa L. Newport. "LLMs as a platform for studying constraint interaction: Motivation and challenges", *Behavioral and Brain Sciences*, 2026

Manuscripts and Theses

[1] **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**, Roger Levy, Kathryn Davidson. "Presupposing Novel Information: A Cross-Trigger Experiment in English" lingBuzz preprint, 2023

[2] **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**, "Informative Presupposition and Accommodation", Ph.D. Dissertation, Harvard University, 2022.

[3] Richard Futrell, **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**, Takashi Morita, and Roger Levy, "RNNs as psycholinguistic subjects: Syntactic state and grammatical dependency", arXiv preprint, 2018.

[4] **Ethan Gotlieb Wilcox**, "Revolutionary Linguistics: The Ideology of the Soviet Esperanto Movement 1917-1938", BA Honors Thesis, Stanford University, 2015

Invited Presentations

Invited Conference & Workshop Talks

- "Using Not-so-Large LMs to Study Human Language Acquisition", Symposium on Language Development, co-located with the BU Conference on Language Development, Boston, MA (11/25)
- "Language Modeling in People and Machines", ICML Workshop on Large Language Models and Cognition, International Conference on Machine Learning, Vienna, Austria (7/24)
- "Using artificial neural networks to study human language processing: Two case studies and a warning", Workshop on Using Artificial Neural Networks for Studying Human Language Learning and Processing, Institute for Language Logic and Computation, University of Amsterdam, The Netherlands (6/24)
- "Language Models as Cognitive Models: The Cases of Syntactic Generalization and Real-Time Language Comprehension", The Fourth International Conference on Theoretical East Asian Psycholinguistics, Seoul Korea (8/23)

Invited Colloquia / Talk Series

- "Going Beyond *Humanlike*: Using LLMs to Advance Psycholinguistic Theories", Department of Linguistics, Michigan State University. (3/26)
- "Going Beyond *Humanlike*: Using LLMs to Advance Psycholinguistic Theories", Interactions between Formal and Computational Linguistics Seminar Series, Online. (12/25)
- "Going Beyond *Humanlike*: Using LLMs to Advance Psycholinguistic Theories", Integrated Language Science and Technology Talk Series, University of Pennsylvania, Philadelphia PA. (10/25)
- "Informational Overlap between Linguistic Channels: Prosody as a Case Study", Language and Cognition Talk Series, Harvard University, Cambridge MA. (10/25)
- "Cognition and LLMs: Using Artificial Neural Networks to Understand Human Language Processing", The Undergraduate Interdisciplinary Program in Cognitive Science Colloquium, Georgetown University (04/25)
- "Using artificial neural networks to study human language processing", Deep Linguistic Modeling Research Colloquium, Heinrich Heine University Düsseldorf (12/24)
- "Using artificial neural networks to study human language processing", Cognitive Science Seminar Series, University of Michigan, USA. (11/24)
- "Using Mouse Tracking for Reading (MoTR) to investigate agreement and attachment in online language comprehension", Department of Linguistics, University Marburg, Germany (11/24)
- "Information-Theoretic Perspectives on Language Comprehension", Complex Human Data Hub, University of Melbourne, Australia (10/23)

- "Learning and Processing Linguistic Structure in Humans and Machines", Department of Cognitive Science, Johns Hopkins University, USA. (2/23)
- "Using Computational Models to Test Syntactic Learnability", Department of Linguistics, University of Geneva, Switzerland. (12/22)
- "Structure and Statistical Processing in Humans and Machines", Department of Linguistics, Yale University, USA. (3/22)
- "Using Computational Models to Test Syntactic Learnability", Department of English, Dongguk University, Korea. (1/22)
- "Using Presuppositions to Introduce Novel Information", Department of Linguistics (Universals Colloquium Series), Harvard University, USA. (11/21)
- "How to Evaluate Neural Networks as Models of Linguistic Cognition", Department of English, Dongguk University, Korea. (2/21)

Lab Talks / Other Invited Presentations

- "Using artificial neural networks to study human language processing", Language and Intelligence Lab, MIT, USA. (11/24)
- "Structure and Statistical Processing in Humans and Machines", Language, Logic Learning Lab, UC Davis, USA. (5/22)
- "Neural Network Language Models and the Argument from the Poverty of the Stimulus", Department of Linguistics (Ling Lunch Series), Massachusetts Institute of Technology, USA. (10/19)
- "Using Structure to Predict the next Word: What RNN Language Models Learn about Syntax", Computation and Psycholinguistics Lab, Johns Hopkins University, USA. (2/19)
- "What do RNN Language Models Learn about the Filler-Gap Dependency?", Psycholinguistics and Cognitive Science Laboratory, Ecole Normale Supérieure (Paris), France (8/18)

Grants and Awards

Awards

- Senior Area Chair Award, Association for Computational Linguistics Annual Meeting 08/2025
  Using Information Theory to Characterize Prosodic Typology
- Outstanding Paper Award, Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing 12/2023
  Language Model Quality Correlates with Psychometric Predictive Power in Multiple Languages
- Outstanding Paper Award, Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing 12/2023
  Revisiting the Optimality of Word Lengths
- Best Honors Thesis, Division of Languages, Cultures and Literatures, Stanford University 6/2015
  Revolutionary Linguistics: The ideology of the Soviet Esperanto movement, 1917-1938

Grants

- ETH Zurich Postdoctoral Fellowship 1/2021 - present
  Evaluating Large Language Models with Human Psycholinguistic Data
- Graduate Student Research Grant, Mind Brain Behavior Initiative, Harvard 1/2021
  Experimental and computational assessment of presuppositions' contextual felicity constraints
- Graduate Student Research Grant, Mind Brain Behavior Initiative, Harvard 10/2019
  Workshop on linguistics and climate change
- Graduate Student Research Grant, Mind Brain Behavior Initiative, Harvard 5/2018
  Can neural nets learn linguistic dependencies?

Teaching and Advising

Teaching Experience

As a Primary Instructor (all at Georgetown University)

- LLMs for Computational Linguistics [Syllabus, GU360 Course Site] S'26
- Computational Linguistics Research Methods [Syllabus, GU360 Course Site] F'25
- Computational Language Processing [Syllabus, GU360 Course Site] F'24, S'25, S'26, F'26
- Information, Structure and Language (Graduate Seminar) [Syllabus, GU360 Course Site] F'24, F'26

PhD Theses Supervised as Primary Advisor

PhD Theses Supervised as Secondary Advisor

- Tatsuya Aoyama. "Inductive Bias, Emergent Structure, and Pretraining Data in Cognitive Modeling", PhD Thesis, Georgetown University, Department of Linguistics, 2025.

PhD Theses Supervised as a Committee Member / Reviewer

- Julius Steuer, "Developmental, Typological, and Diachronic Applications of Cognitively Plausible Language Models" PhD Thesis, University of Saarland, Department of Language Science & Technology, 2026.
- Autumn Toney, "Contextualized Capabilities: Strengths and Limitations of LLMs in Factual and Human-Like Text Generation Across Applications", PhD Thesis, Georgetown University, Department of Computer Science, 2025.

Masters Theses Supervised as Primary Advisor

- Samuel Kiegeland. "Reverse-Engineering the Reader: Aligning Language Models to Psychometric Data", Masters Thesis, ETH, Department of Computer Science, 2024.
- Cui Ding. "Mouse Tracking for Reading (MoTR): A New Incremental Processing Paradigm", Masters Thesis, University of Zürich, Department of Computational Linguistics, 2023.
  – *Awarded a "Semesterpreis" for outstanding thesis*
- Lukas Wolf. "On the Contribution of Prosody to Language Comprehension in Large Language Models", Masters Thesis, ETH Zürich, Department of Computer Science, 2023.

Undergraduate Theses Supervised as Primary Advisor

- Anastasia Kelly. "Can conventionality and contingency deliver the goods on idioms cross-linguistically? A multilingual analysis of the metrics of conventionality and contingency", Undergraduate Honors Thesis, Department of Linguistics, Georgetown University, 2026.

Academic Service

Conference Organization

- Organizing Committee, BabyLM Challenge 2023-
  – *Organized a shared task on sample-efficient language modeling with 30+ submissions each year*
  – *The BabyLM Challenge was featured in a New York Times article about democratizing AI research*

Departmental/University Service

- Member, AI Certificate Steering Committee, Georgetown University 2026-
- Linguistics Lab Director, Department of Linguistics, Georgetown University 2024-
  – *Maintained laboratory space, infrastructure, and equipment on behalf of the department*
  – *Organized purchase and maintenance of computer cluster (GPU) nodes on behalf of the department*
- Graduate Student Representative, Department of Linguistics, Harvard University 2020-2022

– *Represent departmental graduate student interests to the faculty and university*
– *Implemented first ever department climate survey; ran graduate portion of new faculty search*

Reviewing

- **Journals:** Nature (Springer), Cognitive Science (Wiley), Journal of Memory and Language (Elsevier); Open Mind (MIT Press); Behavior Research Methods (Springer); Journal of Linguistics (Cambridge); Language Acquisition (Taylor & Francis)
- **Funding Agencies:** NSF (Linguistics, 2025); Israel Science Foundation (2025); European Research Commission (Advanced Grant, 2023)
- **Conferences:** ACL Rolling Review (2022–), *ACL conferences (2020–2022), SCiL (2026), CoNLL (2026), COLING (2022), CogSci (2021, 2025), Meaning in Context Workshop at ICLR (2021)
  – *Outstanding reviewer recognition, EMNLP, 2020*

Professional Experience

Transcendent Endeavors — New York, NY
Computational Linguist — 10/16 –8/17

Carnegie Endowment for International Peace and Freelance — Moscow and Remote
Translator and Editor — 10/15 –10/16

Palantir — Palo Alto, CA
Product Quality Engineer Intern — 6/14 –9/14

Selected Translations

All work co-translated from Russian with Mikhail Lion

- "Sanctions and Retaliation: Where Russia–U.S. Relations are Headed", Andrey Movchan, *Carnegie Center Moscow*. 2018.
- "Is Putin Losing Control of Russia's Conservative Nationalists?", Alexander Baunov, *Foreign Affairs*, 2017
- "The Accidental Formation of Russia's War Coalition", Konstantin Gaaze, *Carnegie Center Moscow*, 2017
- "Going to the People–and Back Again: The Changing Shape of the Russian Regime" (white paper), Alexander Baunov, Carnegie Center Moscow, 2017
- "The Snow Queen" (stage play), Evgeny Schwartz, produced by: The Wilma Theater, Philadelphia PA (2025); Dacha Theater, Seattle WA (2016)

References

Roger Levy
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Richard Futrell
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Kathryn Davidson
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Ryan Cotterell
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Department of Computer Science
Institute for Machine Learning
ETH Zürich
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